

Beginner's Guide to Fitness

Getting Started

Consistency beats intensity when starting out - three predictable sessions a week for months outperforms an intense week followed by burnout.

Learn movement technique with light or bodyweight loads before adding significant weight; poor form under load is the leading cause of avoidable injury.

Expect a 1-2 week adjustment period where soreness (DOMS) is normal; this fades as the body adapts.

First 4 Weeks - Full Body Plan

Day	Focus	Example Exercises	Sets x Reps
Day 1	Full Body A	Squat, Push-up, Row, Plank	2-3 x 10-12
Day 2	Rest / Light Walk	-	-
Day 3	Full Body B	Deadlift (light), Overhead Press, Lat Pulldown, Dead Bug	2-3 x 10-12
Day 4	Rest	-	-
Day 5	Full Body A	Repeat Day 1 with slightly more weight if form was solid	2-3 x 10-12

Common Beginner Mistakes

Skipping warm-ups: 5-10 minutes of light cardio plus movement-specific warm-up sets reduces injury risk and improves performance.

Program hopping: switching routines every week prevents the progressive overload needed to see results - stick with a plan for at least 6-8 weeks.

Ignoring nutrition: training drives the stimulus for change, but diet and sleep determine whether the body actually adapts.

Comparing to advanced lifters: progress is highly individual; beginners typically see the fastest relative strength gains of any training stage (often called 'newbie gains').

How to Progress

Once all sets can be completed with good form at the top of the rep range, add a small amount of weight (2.5-5%) or one rep next session.

Track workouts in a notebook or app - what gets measured gets improved.